



Hardware-Assisted Dynamic Heat Redistribution Using PCM and Logic Control for Efficient Thermal Management in Advanced VLSI

Paper ID: 1144

Track No:01

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IEEE International Conference on Emerging Technologies in
Engineering Applications
14-15 May 2026, Puducherry, India

ICETEA 2026

INTRODUCTION

- Advanced VLSI systems operate at high transistor density, leading to increased power density and thermal hotspots
- Hotspots negatively impact performance, reliability, and device lifespan
- Existing thermal techniques (DVFS, cooling systems) suffer from latency, power overhead, and limited adaptability
- A real-time, hardware-based thermal management approach using PCM and logic control is required

PROBLEM STATEMENT

- Localized hotspots cause performance degradation, leakage increase, and accelerated aging.
- Passive methods (PCM alone) lack control over heat redistribution.
- Software-based thermal management introduces delay and inefficient response.
- Absence of a low-latency, adaptive on-chip thermal control mechanism.

EXISTING SOLUTION

- DVFS and software-based thermal control introduce latency and reduce overall system performance during operation.
- Heat sinks and conventional cooling techniques operate mainly at the package level and do not provide effective on-chip thermal management.
- Passive PCM cooling can absorb heat temporarily but suffers from saturation and lacks control over heat redistribution.
- Existing approaches do not provide real-time, localized, and adaptive thermal redistribution within the chip.

PROPOSED FRAMEWORK

- The proposed framework introduces a PCM-assisted, logic-controlled thermal management system for efficient heat regulation in VLSI circuits.
- It integrates thermal sensing, hardware-based control, and heat redistribution mechanisms to manage localized hotspots.
- The framework enables real-time, low-latency thermal response without relying on software-based control.

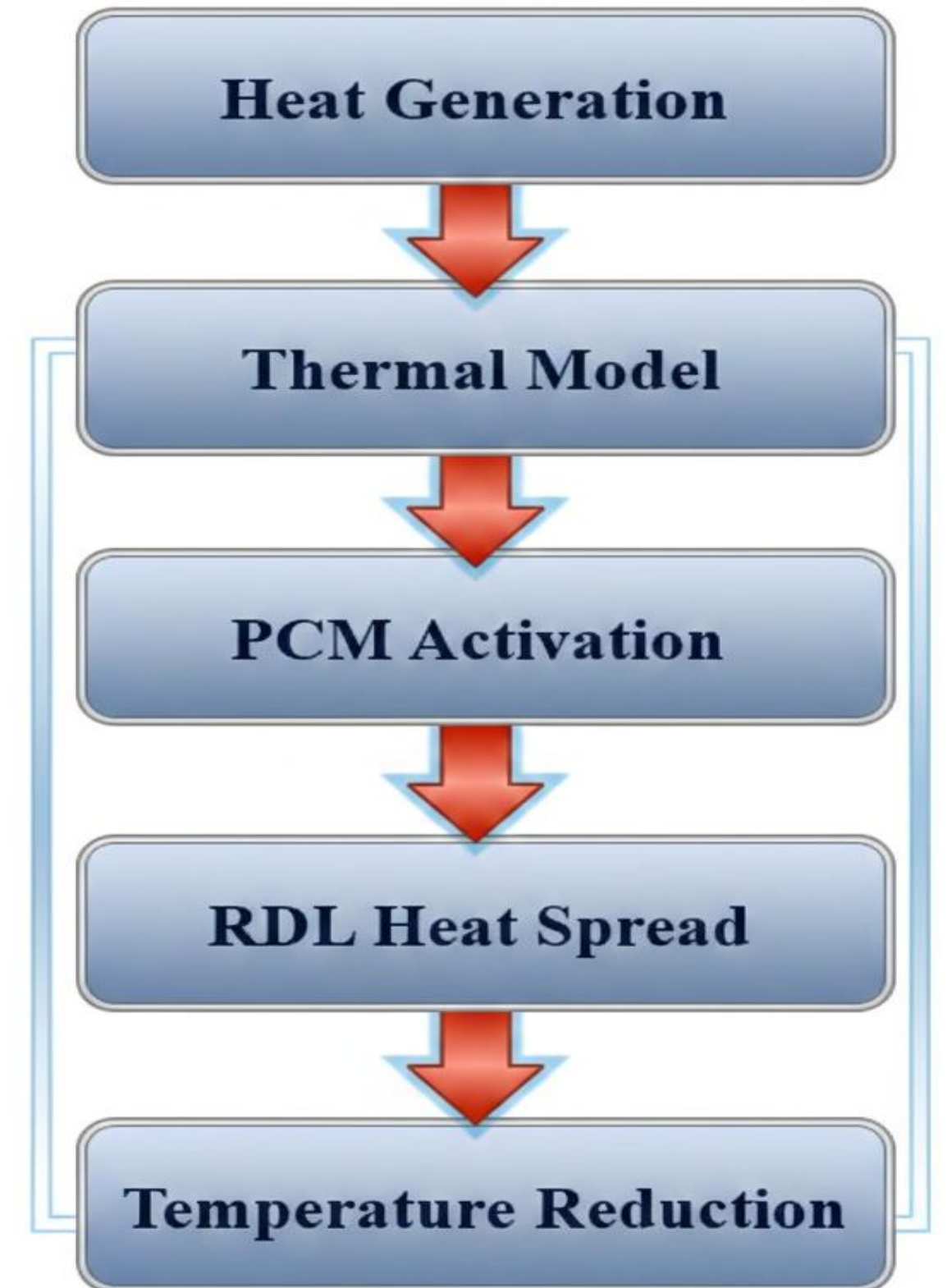


Figure 1.1. High-level operational flow of the PCM-assisted thermal management system

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

- The system consists of thermal sensors, a logic control unit, PCM regions, and a redistribution layer forming a closed-loop architecture.
- Temperature data from sensors is continuously monitored and processed by the control unit to detect hotspot conditions.
- When a threshold is exceeded, PCM absorbs heat and the redistribution layer spreads it, ensuring dynamic thermal stabilization.

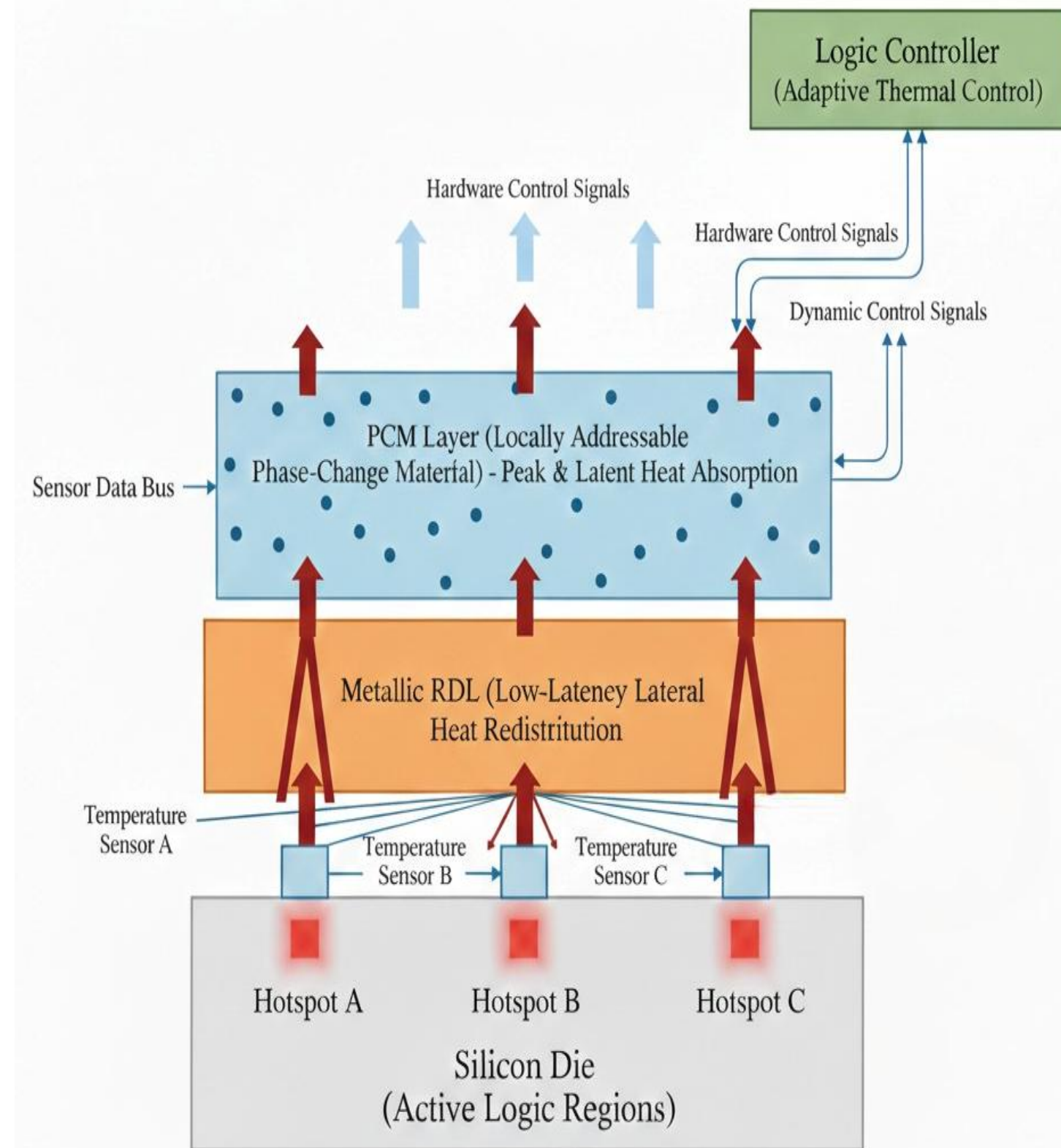


Figure 1.2. On-chip PCM-assisted architecture with logic-controlled heat redistribution

SIMULATION & VALIDATION

- The proposed system is validated using multiphysics thermal simulation (ElmerSolver) along with control logic verification.
- Simulation models include heat conduction, PCM phase transition, and dynamic heat redistribution across the chip.
- Results confirm effective hotspot detection and real-time activation of control signals for thermal regulation.

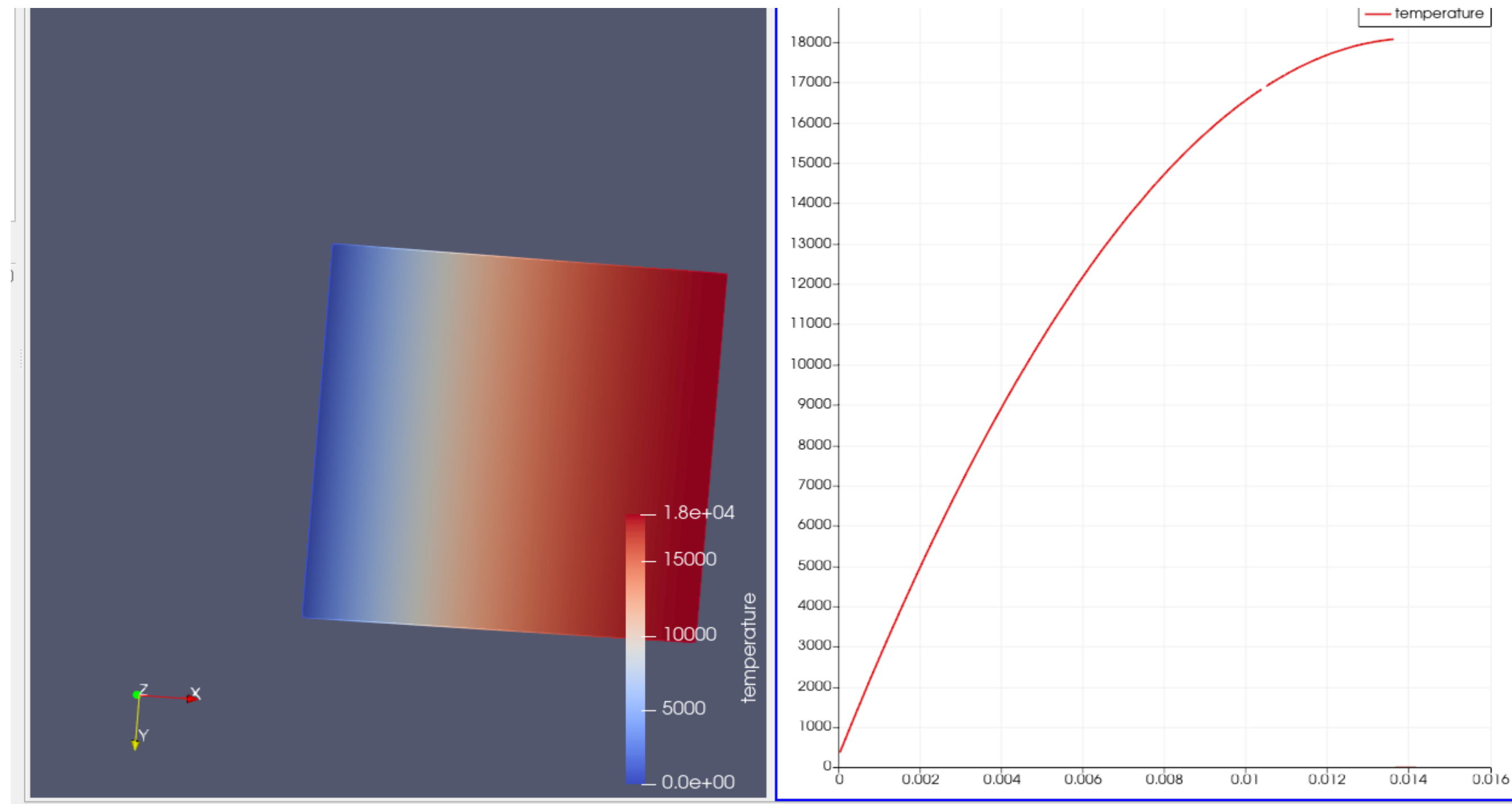


Figure 1.3. Thermal distribution and simulation response of the proposed system

RESULT & DISCUSSION

- The proposed approach achieves significant reduction in peak hotspot temperature and improved thermal uniformity.
- Dynamic response analysis shows fast stabilization of temperature under varying thermal conditions.
- Overall system demonstrates efficient, low-latency thermal management compared to conventional methods.

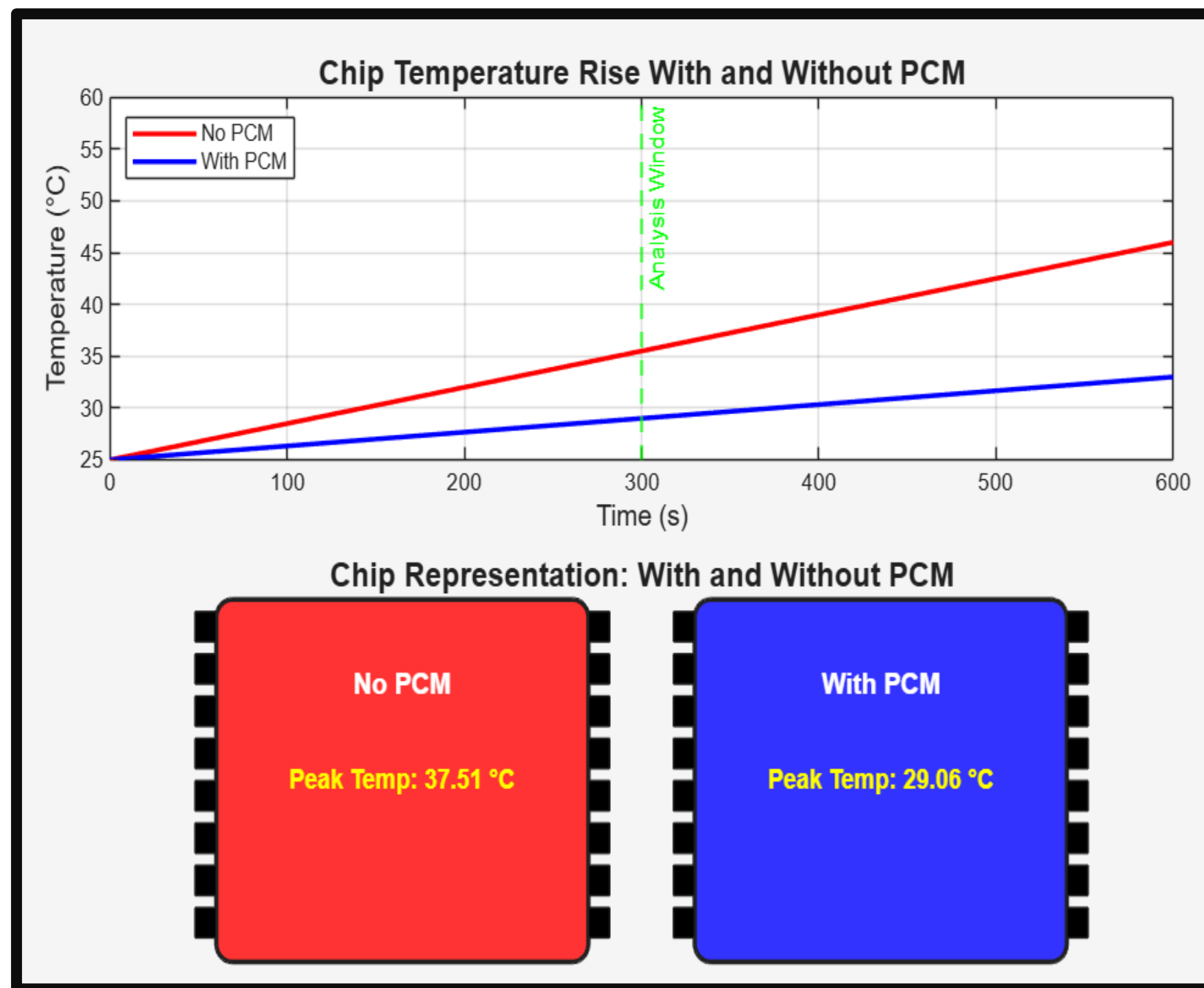


Figure 1.4. Temperature comparison with and without PCM showing reduced peak temperature

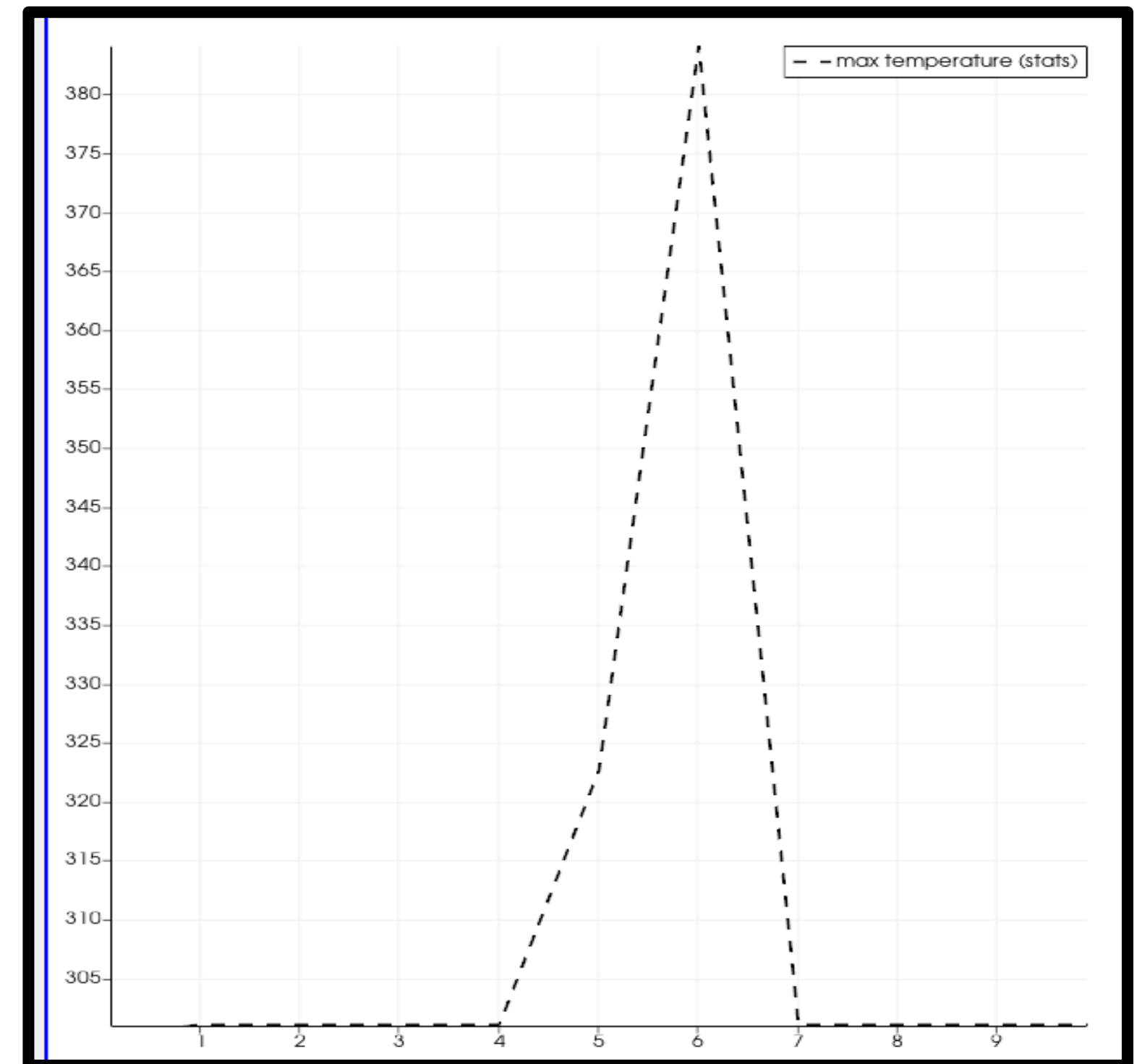


Figure 1.5. Dynamic hotspot temperature response over time

COMPARISON WITH EXISTING THERMAL MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUES

Technique	Response Time	Control Type	Efficiency	Limitation
DVFS	High latency	Software-based	Moderate	Performance loss
Heat Sink / Cooling	Slow	Passive	Moderate	No on-chip control
PCM (Passive)	Medium	Passive	Good	Saturation issue
Software Thermal Control	High latency	Software	Moderate	Delayed response
Proposed System	Near-zero latency	Hardware-based	High	Needs hardware validation

CONCLUSION & FUTURE WORK

- The proposed framework achieves real-time hotspot mitigation using PCM-assisted logic control with near-zero latency.
- It improves thermal stability, reduces peak temperature, and enhances overall system reliability.
- The system is scalable, energy-efficient, and compatible with CMOS fabrication processes.
- Future work includes hardware implementation, FPGA prototyping, and advanced PCM material optimization.

THANK YOU!